The Rib of Saint Hussey

PLOT ON ONE PAGE · GM ONLY

Get a saint's rib out of Aubrecht and into his tomb at Wendholt by dusk on his feast day, a hard day's road east, past a canon who wants it back.

THE JOB

A hundred years ago Hussey, a lay brother of Wendholt, carried the plague dead out of Aubrecht for forty days, then went home and died. The cathedral of Saint Aubrel's dug him up and kept his bones; the sick pay to be near them. The Cardinal has ordered the rib home. **Sister Eulalia** (19, quick, sharp, a mule called Patience) hires the heroes: a purse each and a seat at the feast.

THE SECRET

Canon Rainald Pell, sacrist of Saint Aubrel's, keeps the treasury and its coin. He has a copy made (matching case, pig's rib, sacristy seal) and tries to swap it in: in the crowd (1), at the gate (2), on the road (3), and at the feast itself (5), where he arrives first by coach.

1 The Snatch · Aubrecht · Target 12

Handover on the cathedral steps. **Wat Gilder** cuts the case away and runs: chase through the fish market and over the roofs (chase table). Cornered, he hands over the real rib and the copy, and names a steward in black gloves.

2 The Gate · the east gate · Target 12

Pell has told the watch the heroes are relic thieves. The players choose how to get out: bluff with the Cardinal's letter, hide under bones in the ossuary cart, over the wall, or a carters' brawl. Keep the copy: its seal matters later.

3 The Riders · the east road · Target 13

Konrad Hask, Pell's polite hired rider, offers a house-sized purse for the case. Refused, he shoots the horse and the hay wagon runs away down the hill. On Hask: **Pell's letter**, the proof. Take the deal, and the ending changes.

4 Brackford Ferry · River Wend at dusk · Target 13

Pilgrims who drowned trying to reach Hussey's tomb climb onto the barge reaching for the rib: **Gaunt Penitents**. Steel drops them; the rib's healing lays one to rest (its usual Horror). Once one rests, the others follow at a distance.

5 The Feast at Wendholt · green and chapel · Target 13

Bonfires and fiddles. Pell is already there with the fake, calling the heroes thieves. Win the village (the letter wins it at once), or at dusk the Penitents walk straight past his case to the real rib. Eulalia lays the saint in his tomb.

THE RIB

Catalogue relic **Rib of the Hospice Saint**, unchanged: heal d8 in Close or Near, once per person per rest, 2 Horror (1 for a Barber-surgeon). One slot; counts towards three Horror items. Each time it heals the living, +1 Penitent at the ferry.

HORROR

7	+2 Penitents at the ferry.
14	One crawls out of a ditch in scene 3.
21	All left at the ferry come to the feast.

ENDINGS

- **Real rib in the tomb:** the dead lie down on the green, the fiddles start again, Wendholt eats the pig. Rewards: purse, Saint's Knucklebone, Pell's Reliquary key, a Blank indulgence.
- **Took Hask's deal:** the copy goes in the tomb and the feast is lovely. The drowned follow the real rib back to Aubrecht, and the cathedral starts shutting its doors at dusk. That is the next adventure.

ALSO IN IT

Father Benedikt Rook (wants to believe Pell) · Reeve Gisela Moor (trusts nobody from the city) · Tamsin the Ferrywoman